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And I will make thee beds of roses, With a thousand fragrant posies,
A cap of flowers and a kirtle, Embroidered all with leaves of myrtle.

THE PASSIONATE SHEPHERD TO HIS LOVE, CHRISTOPHER MARLOWE C.1589

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1520–39	1540–59	1560–64	1565–99	1600–20	1621–24
1520 Spanish Conquistadors defeat the Aztecs in Mexico. Cochineal used as a red dye is brought back to Europe. ▼ Collecting cochineal beetles 		1560–1600 Men's clothes get narrower on shoulders and longer.		1605 Hemlines go up to show feet, following the introduction of heeled shoes for the rich, hence the expression “well heeled”.	1620s Coloured stockings, especially red ones, become popular. The newer style of latchet-closing shoe shows off the hose underneath, and embroidery at the ankle.
		1562 English legislate against the wearing of “monstrous and outrageous greatness of hose” after fashion for padding tops of legs reaches ridiculous proportions.		1600s In ladieswear, the short jacket is introduced. These are initially closed with ribbons, later with metal hooks and eyes. They are worn by all stations of society but the materials depend on rank. Boned bodices cinch in waist and lift the barely covered breasts.	1620s Surface ornamentation of fabrics is replaced by bright, solid-colour satins decorated with rosettes, wide bows, and looped trims. For women, the virago sleeve – full slashed sleeve divided into two puffs at the elbow by a ribbon or trim – comes in.
	1540 The codpiece reaches its peak in terms of size and decoration. Designed to cover the gap between the two legs of men's hose, it is padded and shaped to emphasize rather than disguise the genital area.		▲ Pope Pius V wearing his white habit 1566 Pope Pius V is credited with changing the colour of the papal robes from red to white, as he would not give up his Dominican habit.		
▲ Intricate lacework 1527 Mateo Pagano in Italy and Pierre de Quinty in Cologne publish the first pattern books for embroidery and lace-making.	1550s The chopine, an early platform overshoe, has been popular since the late 15th century. At this time they reach the peak of their height (50 cm/20 in). 		1570s Introduction of the French, or “wheel”, farthingale, with a stuffed roll around the hips and a hoop with horizontal stiffeners tied around the waist that makes the skirt stick out from the body. ◀ Reconstruction of a farthingale underskirt	1600–1650 Ruffs are replaced by broad collars of lace. Hats become taller and broader with brims, sleeves get puffier. ▶ The <i>Laughing Cavalier</i> by Franz Hals (1624)	
	▲ Punched, kid leather and pine chopine from Venice, Italy	1564 Starching is introduced from the Low Countries and allows for the development of large, stiff ruffs. Starch can be coloured yellow or blue to tint the ruff.		1620 English Puritans establish a colony in Plymouth, Massachusetts. Sombre colours and tall, black capotain hats are worn; lacings and jewellery are forbidden by Puritans.	1625 Fashionable married women abandon the wearing of a cap and wear their hair elaborately styled, uncovered, or with a hat.